

From the Bureau of the International Press

Esteemed Delegates,

We welcome you to the International Press Corps. There's a certain level of irony it takes to draft a background guide for a committee that's meant to resist templates. After all, you are supposed to create narratives, not be handed one. But even dissent needs a direction, and briefing the press on how not to be briefed is, perhaps, the most paradoxically important part of this committee. Within the context of the United Nations (UN), and out of it, the press plays an invaluable role in shaping the narrative. As a part of the Press, you will not only hold power to account, but also to redirect the discussion. With the rise in misinformation, the role of the press is no longer limited to mere documentation; rather, it becomes democracy's deadliest weapon.

We trust you to conduct yourself within the principles that journalism dictates. Maintain clarity, report with precision, be well-researched beforehand, and work within the bounds of liberty granted by the conference. However, remember that you are not subordinated to diplomacy, but rather a parallel force alongside.

While reporters rely on their pen, the camera often proves to be mightier. Pictures possess an unmatched ability to convey a narrative instantly, with depth and clarity that overcome time and text constraints. Your photographs anchor the written reports, providing visceral connections to the proceedings.

In this edition of AICON, this committee is tasked with delivering insights to the masses and ensuring accountability through documentation and inquiry. Your role for the duration of this conference will not only determine how the conference is remembered, but also how it is understood through a newsletter that will be collectively published by the Press Corps.

Here are a few instructions to take note of before committee begins:

★ Originality and Ethics

Specifically for reporters, plagiarism in any form, including copying from external sources without attribution, presenting another's work as one's own, or recycling articles from previous conferences, is unacceptable and will not be tolerated. Likewise, usage of AI software to produce or facilitate the production of your work is strictly discouraged and may lead to disqualification from editorial consideration. Cite sources wherever necessary.

★ Capture the Scene, not just the moment

While deadlines must be maintained, ensure your work is a perfect balance between certainty and conception. Produce work of the highest possible quality, even if that comes at the expense of a minor delay. Remember that you are not a stenographer.

Your work, be it articles or pictures, must resonate stories beyond what's visible to the eye. Specific to the reporters, as important as opinions are to spark collective critical thinking, they often create a pathway towards bias when they become the focal point. Your articles may reflect opinion as long as they do not disregard decorum or reflect editorial favouritism. Submissions that require refinement for clarity will be edited in the best interest of the newsletter's standard.

★ Collaborate, then Compete

Journalism, in its truest form, thrives on independence and accountability, which cannot be achieved by division. While the byline carries a single name, the strength of the press lies in its collective unity. At its core, the aim of the press is to deliver an exceptional newsletter, and that requires collaboration above everything else. You are required to work closely with your fellow reporters and photojournalists for the best possible outcome. The story is always bigger than the storyteller.

★ Research Before You Report

Real journalism begins before the committee. Read up on the agenda of the committee you have been allotted to, understand the politics, and come with thoughtful questions. Reporters have the liberty to interview delegates whenever deemed necessary, not just for formality. Reflect your research in your articles and let your pictures show stories of context. The best reporting exhibits both background context and real-time insight.

Often mistaken for a passive role, the press holds a reserved seat at the table of diplomacy. You must track progress in your council in real time, and engage with delegates and diplomats representing diverse portfolios. Remember that your coverage is not to be limited to a mere summary or a bland shot. We expect creative submissions which tell stories beyond the obvious.

As members of the press, you hold the rare privilege of seeing the conference at a macro level. Unlike delegates from other committees, you are not confined to one council. You are permitted to observe the proceedings in committees that are not allotted to you as long as you do not cause any disruption. You may use this liberty to construct coherence in your work. Observe contrasts and patterns and use it to your advantage. You may draw parallels and question decisions made by the same portfolio in two different debates. Let your words and pixels not show just isolated events, rather a unified account that would amplify the inconsistencies that often go unnoticed.

We encourage you to review this background guide thoroughly, keeping an open, curious, and creative mind. Gauge how to implement any part of your research in the best way possible. We wish you all the best, and please don't hesitate to contact us if you have any doubts. Feel free to drop your queries at siyaanandd@gmail.com. Remember, news is something someone wants suppressed. Everything else is just advertising.

Regards,
Siya Anand: Head of International-Press

Rupsa Bhattacharjee: Editor-in-Chief

About The International Press

Unlike other committees, the International Press (IP) does not have a mandate, simply because it is not a traditional part of the United Nations. The IP functions parallel to the conference like it would to any other event. The corps consists of journalists and photojournalists representing media houses from across the world providing their account of the proceedings that take place inside the closed walls of each committee to inform the masses.

Before social media, the Press was the only source of news the people had and reportage was a bigger priority than dissecting information, unlike today, where the press shapes public opinion and delivers perspectives that often go unnoticed. The role of the press is much more than merely informing.

With misinformation, digital propaganda, and algorithm control on the rise, it is next to impossible to decipher what is fabricated and what is not. This lack of factual certainty is what gives rise to the need for credible sources. Which is why, in the simulation of the IP in Model United Nations conferences, the committee consists of media houses with diverse perspectives to bring together the most informative articles of varied approaches for the newsletter.

The IP is not an auxiliary unit. It engages in its own arguments and negotiation through headlines and interviews. Much like the real world, the IP holds considerable soft power to redirect the flow of arguments and public sentiment making the body more of a strategic actor.

The most pressing intellectual challenge in the world is the monopoly over truth production. States no longer compete only in arms and economics, but also in narratives. Every geopolitical player deploys their own resources and perspectives from time to time to influence how stories are told. Within the context of MUN, it is the power of the press to critically investigate and contextualise speeches, resolutions, and crises, not just quote them.

The IP consists mainly of 2 parts here.

1. **Journalism:** The role of a journalist lies much beyond reporting. As a journalist, you must amplify the unnoticed and bring attention to matters of relevance. As mentioned probably more than twice earlier in the background guide, there is a fine line between putting forth views and a bias. It is the role of the journalist to strike the perfect balance between both offering the reader a stable perspective without distortion. A journalist must not only observe the dynamics in the room but also pay attention to side conversations and how things are said rather than just focusing on what is being said. They serve as the ears and eyes of the outside world embedded in the conference. Journalists are also tasked with interpreting and simplifying jargon into

clear and digestible information in the interest of the public. At its core, your task is simple but vital: notice what others miss, and write what others need to know.

JOURNALISM

You will be allotted a certain number of submissions at the beginning of each day based on the discretion of the Executive Board. The deadlines for each day will be notified at the beginning of the first session for the day. The deadlines are not bound by committee time and may be scheduled even after the last session of the day. What stands certain is that throughout the conference, you will have atleast one article of each type as long as the conference duration permits it. Each article will be marked with objective criteria ensuring that even with a change in the Executive board the results will be the same. We understand how overwhelming it can be to take in a lot of information at once but, we still encourage you to go through the entire guide atleast once before the conference.

Types of Submissions

The types of submissions are mainly sectioned into the following:

1. Committee bound

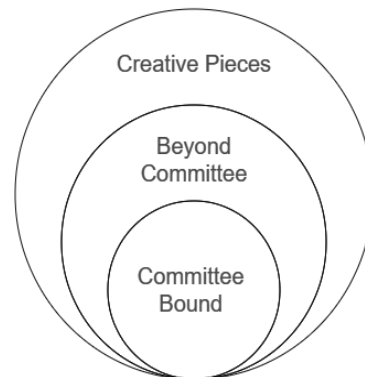
- a. Beat based article
- b. Committee Report

2. Beyond Committee

- a. Opinionated editorial
- b. Opinionated poll
- c. Interview
- d. Context Report

3. Creatives

- a. Feature Submissions



Keep in mind, the “beyond committee” and “creative pieces” can also consist of details from the debates going on in committee. Each Submission has been explained in detail further in the background guide.

Beat-Based Article

While there is a specific agenda at hand in every committee, there are always auxiliary discussions that take place. Here, you pick either an entire sub agenda, or even just a speech from the committee proceedings to draft your entire article. It will take the mantle as the core concern of the article, and the content should closely conform to the central idea. The main goal of this article lies in capturing the pulse of the committee through a specialised piece which requires in-depth research and offers more knowledge to the reader. It must be a topic important enough to attract readership.

Word Limit: 350-400

Committee report

A committee report in essence, is just a bunch of beats put together. This article is supposed to inform the reader about the proceedings of the committee without any bias—basically a beat (I am not going to stop stressing on this). Write about each moderated caucus, highlight the key proceedings, inform the readers how the discussion swayed before the resolution was drafted. Remember, you are not a stenographer. We don't want a play out of the Rules of Procedure. We want quality content that was spoken in committee. Ensure that someone who is not a part of the committee can still read your report and understand what is going on.

Word Count- 600-650

Opinionated Editorial

An opinionated editorial (Op-Ed) is a piece of writing that expresses a personal opinion typically printed opposite the page on which the editorial is printed. For this article you are not bound by committee proceedings, rather, you are allowed to write about the actual scenario. Make a clear point and have supporting arguments backing up your thoughts. An Op-Ed requires Low research and a high amount of opinions but this does not allow you to completely omit the addition of information. While the opinion you wish to put forth may be common, we highly encourage your arguments to be detailed and provide us with a newer understanding.

Word count: 600-800

Opinionated-Poll

An Opinionated Poll or an Op-Poll, is used to bring light to the inclination of the committee. You are required to float a question in your assigned committee that would potentially yield polarized results. You may express your opinion (in line with your agency's views) in any way you like when you analyse the outcome. Feel free to make use of graphs and statistical inferences in this submission.

Word Limit: 250- 350

Interview report

As journalists you have the liberty to ask questions. Either pick one delegate or a group of delegates—whatever floats your boat. Gain insight on their perspective regarding the agenda. Introspect. Ask questions of relevance and gain information. Your aim here is not to press them and point out their shortcomings, rather know what they're doing and how their plan on resolving the issue at hand. The findings of this report can further be used in other articles as well as during the presscon. Do your research and be prepared with questions beforehand. Remember that you are not limited to your questions and can change your questions during the interview to make it more fruitful. Limit yourself to 5 or 6 short precise questions. Keep the transcribing intact and only mention the essence. Again, you're not a stenographer. Include only relevant details in your transcription.

Word Limit: 250-300

Context reports

Much similar to an op-ed, in this article you provide your opinion on a specific event or document. You will be required to make this article research intensive and very analytical in nature. Break down the tiniest details, over analyse the usage of words, point out flaws in the document that might have catastrophic ramifications. Feel free to reference other events and documents to substantiate your work further but make sure that the entire article must be based on one key selection.

500-800 words

Feature Submissions

Do whatever you like, as long as relevant to the agenda. The aim of a feature submission is to underscore the purpose of influential symbolism to reflect the agenda at hand. While we understand that limiting creativity to a word limit doesn't really make sense, you must understand that the whole point of the press is to generate articles for a newsletter.

Word Limit- 100-800.

Formatting Guidelines

- ★ Font: Times New Roman
- ★ Size and other specifics
 - Title: 14 pts, **Bold**, Centre
 - Byline: 13pts, *italicized*, justified
 - Body: 12pts, normal, justified
- ★ The submission files should be named in the format below:
 - ***Agency Name_Type of Submission_Committee_Day***

example: Reuters_OpEd_UNSC_Day1

- ★ By-lines are mandatory for all types of submissions.

Ensure your byline includes your name, agency, name of the committee you're reporting from, and what are you trying to convey through the article.

- *Example: From the All India Political Parties Meet (AIPPM), Siya Anand, representing the Times of India, examines the likelihood of the discussed pan-national Uniform Civil Code (UCC) to be embedded in patriarchal norms, exclusively regarding the economic dimension of marital justice.*

- ★ Adhere to British English.
- ★ Abbreviations are to be used only once they have been introduced.
 - *Example: From The People's Republic of China's (PRC) brutal Security, to The French Republic's (France) intrusive surveillance laws, and Meta's unethical data practices, the relentless assault on privacy reveals a catastrophic failure of our legal safeguards.*
- ★ Numbers less than ten must be spelled out and those greater than ten must be represented in numerals. Multiples of ten to ninety must also be spelled out.
 - *Example: I have four hours left to finish packing 77 bundles of letters.*
- ★ Avoid using contractions in sentences. Use 'do not' instead of 'don't', and 'cannot' instead of 'can't'.
- ★ Refrain from referring to a delegate by their name. Address them by the portfolio/country they are representing.
 - *Example: The Delegate of the Republic of India highlighted the mass influx of refugees into the country post the Rohingya Crisis.*
- ★ While referring to the same Delegate in the next sentence or in a later part of the paragraph, capitalize the word "Delegate" or "Representative."
- ★ Punctuate properly. The intended delivery of a sentence can be completely misinterpreted just because of a punctuation error. Make use of <http://www.thepunctuationguide.com/> to understand the proper usage of punctuations.
- ★ Plagiarism and AI usage will be dealt with strictly. Cite your sources and references without fail.

- ★ Deadlines are of prime importance. Better three hours too soon than a minute too late.
- ★ Stick to the timeline of your committee. If your committee is based on an event in history, adhere to the time period of that event.
- ★ Relevant pictures must be attached to each of the assigned articles. The source/credit for the picture must be given to the appropriate source/photojournalist using the text box feature in word.
- ★ Ensure your work is not offensive in nature. Your work is to report, not create malice.
- ★ Refrain from using technical terms such as General Speakers List, Moderated Caucus, and so on.